CHARLES FORTNER

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Accomplished Project Manager with 15+ years of experience leading complex IT and telecom projects. Skilled in aligning technology roadmaps with business goals, managing multi-million-dollar portfolios, and leading cross-functional teams. Proven success in optimizing processes, driving financial governance, and delivering projects on time and within budget. PMP and CSM certified, with a focus on driving innovation through effective IT strategies.

***Core Skills**:*

- Project Management (PMP) /SCRUM (CSM)
- Financial (MBA)
- Entrepreneur (nationally recognized)
- Team Leadership & Development
- Sitetracker, Power Apps, Office365
- Technology Infrastructure
- Client Relationship Management
- Architectural & Engineering Management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

10/2020 to 10/2023 **Site Acquisition Department Manager**
Network Connex – Glendale, CA remotely from Columbus, OH

- Directed the real estate entitlements process for a diverse range of wireless projects with major utility and tower companies, including Southern California Edison, Pacific Gas & Electric, Crown Castle, and American Tower Company, covering site hardening, lease renewals, fiber entitlements, modifications, and backhaul infrastructure.
- Collaborated with Site Acquisition, Regulatory, Engineering, Architecture, Permitting, and Construction teams to streamline project workflows, align objectives, and ensure seamless integration of efforts, while regularly coordinating with Senior Leadership and HR to support team development and strategic goals.
- Leveraged advanced technologies (Microsoft Power Platform, PowerApps, Salesforce, Sitetracker) to create and deploy custom online project management systems, tailored for the telecommunications sector requirements.
- Oversaw comprehensive lease management tasks, from preparation using client templates to negotiating terms and securing legal approvals.
- Conducted meticulous review and redlining of architectural and engineering drawings to uphold project integrity and compliance.
- Administered financial oversight, including the request and management of purchase orders, to ensure alignment with project budgets and timelines.

01/2019 to 07/2019 **Director – Professional Services**
Centerline Solutions – Golden, CO remotely from Columbus, OH (company closed 07/2019)

- Led business operations across emerging markets, establishing and nurturing direct relationships with key clients like Verizon, T-Mobile, Crown Castle, Ericsson, and AT&T.
- As Program Manager, showcased leadership in managing services including real estate, architectural & engineering, project management, and utility coordination for both new and modified projects.
- Implemented change management strategies, designed and executed training programs enhancing Centerline's project management processes and system efficiencies.
- Directed team leadership across RF, Site Development, A&E, Field Operations, and Construction, fostering a culture of safety, integrity, and quality.
- Spearheaded business development efforts, expanding the customer and project base within and beyond the wireless service provider sector, including municipal, state, and federal government sectors.
- Drove team development, offering skill enhancement opportunities to staff and managing recruitment to support both existing work and growth.
- Applied over 10 years of direct leadership experience in network implementation within the wireless telecommunications industry to achieve outstanding results.

08/2005 to 12/2018 **Senior Project Manager**
Centerline Solutions – Honolulu, Hawaii

- Managed up to 400 concurrent projects, each valued between $100K and $1M, ensuring timely delivery and adherence to quality standards.
- Led cross-functional teams in engineering, real estate, and construction, driving successful project completion.
- Served as the primary liaison for high-profile clients, enhancing relationships and expanding market reach.
- Led training initiatives, improving team efficiency and project outcomes across multiple markets.
- Oversaw project budgets, ensuring financial compliance and resource optimization throughout all phases.
- Consistently ranked as the top annual producer, contributing to significant revenue growth and company expansion.

*As an entrepreneur who founded Island Page, Charles spearheaded the company's development into a prominent telecommunications service provider, amassing a 30,000-strong subscriber base. He designed and executed a statewide wireless network, led a multifunctional team, and drove business growth through strategic sales and marketing initiatives. His efforts culminated in the profitable sale of the company, after which he continued to provide valuable consultancy. This role showcased his entrepreneurial spirit, strategic vision, and operational expertise.

BACKGROUND

***Formal Education*:**
Bachelor of Science in Finance – THE OHIO STATE UNIVERSITY, Columbus, OH
Master of Business Administration – UNIVERSITY OF PHOENIX, Honolulu, HI

Professional Development:
Project Management Professional (PMP) - Project Management Institute
Certified Scrum Master (CSM) – Scrum Alliance
Dale Carnegie Training: Effective Communications & Human Relations • Leadership Training for Managers • High-Impact Presentations
Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) Citizens Academy: Invitation only opportunity to discover the inner workings of the FBI through 8 weekly classroom trainings.

Technical Skills:
Operating Systems: Windows, Linux
Tools: Office365, Microsoft Teams, Salesforce, Sitetracker, Microsoft Power BI, Project Management Apps, Visual Studio Code (basic), Microsoft Dataverse, Microsoft PowerApps, Microsoft Power Automate
Languages: VBA (basic), Python (basic)

Associations:
Bishop Museum Association Council: Past President, Past Council Member (10k General Members)
Rotary Club of Kahala Sunrise: Past President, Director, Foundation Chair, Assistant Governor
Federal Law Enforcement Foundation: Member
Project Management Institute: (National and Ohio chapter) Member
Scum Alliance: Member

Honors:
National Young Entrepreneur of the Year: U.S. Small Business Administration
Ulupono Award for Community Leadership: Bernice Pauahi Bishop Museum